

Q. You and Sonia Gandhi were quite close. She even came and wished you on your birthday. What went wrong?

A. Meeting and exchanging greetings and politics are two different things.

Q. Amar Singh is suddenly a powerful man and the Government's remote control is in his hands. Do you feel threatened?

A. I am not but the Government will have reasons to feel threatened. Because sooner or later, he will be up to some tricks

Q. You had made charges of corruption

“ I am not feeling threatened but the Government will have reasons to be. Because, sooner or later, he (Amar Singh) will be up to some tricks. ”



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against Amar Singh and Mulayam in the election campaign; you said you would send them to jail after coming to power. But you haven't done anything. So, have you forgiven them?

A. No, that is not the case. The corruption cases against them are going on in the Supreme Court, so why should I come in the middle? Why should I feel scared of such weak people?

Q. Amar Singh and Mulayam have been reborn, they have become more powerful now.

A. I don't think they have become alive again. I still think they are dead and buried politically. Why should I bother to kill someone whom the people have already dealt the death blow to?

Q. But they have breakfast with Manmohan Singh and lunch with Sonia.

A. Dining together is not everything. The way this Government has been saved, it will have to pay a heavy price politically.

Q. Suddenly the cases against you are being revised. Do you think it is the handiwork of the Government's new-found friends?

A. Whenever I have been politically targeted using the CBI or whatever other agency, I have always emerged stronger.

Q. So you are ready for a fight any day? Is that why you keep yourself so fit? Do you do a lot of exercise?

A. No, I don't. My work keeps me busy.

Q. Do you follow a diet regimen?

A. I eat what I get.

Q. Of late, your image has undergone a makeover. Is that part of preparations to ultimately take over as the prime minister?

A. I have done nothing. All this happened naturally. My work keeps me busy and that, I think, is the best exercise I can get.

Q. I am going to ask you a few rapid-fire questions. Who or what is your biggest enemy?

A. I am against discrimination, untouchability and *jaati-vaad*.

Q. And who's your best friend?

A. The day the society that is divided on caste becomes one.

Q. I am asking about individuals. Among the prime ministers, who is your all time favourite?

A. India has had 14 prime ministers, and if I felt any of them was good, I would not have felt the need to form my own party.

Q. Okay then, who was the worst?

A. They are all the same.

Q. Do you watch films?

A. No, but I watch news on TV.

Q. Your favourite food?

A. I like vegetarian food.

Q. If you have to name one villain in today's politics, who would it be?

A. Why single out one? They are all villains.

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